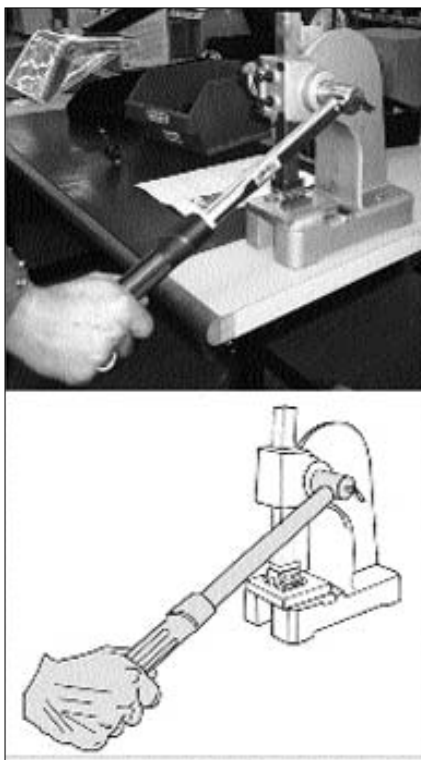


and editing the vector graphics. The image can be changed by editing these objects. They can be stretched, twisted, coloured and so on, with a series of tools. The raster image containing a value for every pixel on the screen is stored in memory. Starting in the earliest days of computing in the 1950s and through the 1980s, a different type of display, the vector graphics system, was used. In these “calligraphic” systems, the electron beam of the CRT display monitor was steered directly to trace out the shapes required, line segment by line segment, with the rest of the screen remaining black. This process was



Vectorise an image to create line art

practiced several times a second (“stroke refresh”) to achieve a flicker-free or near flicker-free picture. These systems allow very high-resolution line art and moving images to be displayed without the (for that time) unthinkable huge amounts of memory that an equivalent-resolution raster system would have needed, and allowed entire sub-pictures to be moved, rotated, blinked, etc. by modifying only a few words of the graphic data “display file”. These vector-based monitors are also known as X-Y displays.

A special type of vector display is known as the storage tube, which has a video tube is similar to Etch-a-Sketch. As the electron beam moves across the screen, an array of small low-power electron